

The Tweetup taught us that it's all about 'free beer', and hardly about 'free speech' ;-)

A Tweetup is an event where people who use Twitter oridenti.ca come together to meet in person. Normally, we connect with our friends online after we have met them. At a Tweetup, you meet the people you might only otherwise know virtually.

LFV had very recently hopped on to the social media bandwagon and decided to make itself visible on the Twitterverse, as well. In the past two months, we managed to rake up more than a hundred followers. Given the kind of opportunity we got while organising an event as huge as OSI '09, we couldn't resist meeting up, face to face, with a few of our friends and followers from Chennai. Of course, the fact we had beer on the house helped the cause.

We finally got face-to-face with those like @PlaneMad, @narananh, @indiblogger and @abbattoir, whom we'd only known online. While the agenda of the meet was to discuss the latest social media rage, businesses sprouting up around them and the marketing opportunities opening up, we wanted to figure out how to amalgamate

the open source ethos with micro-blogging services like Twitter and identi.ca.

One of the most important, but probably not so startling, discoveries was that the social media world cares more about the work than the tool itself. As @PlaneMad had put it, "We do not really care whether a software is free or not, as long as it doesn't cost us a penny. Yes, we would always like to discourage piracy. But, that is the max we would care about."

This makes us wonder—if you are a marketer or a sales guy, would you really care whether a particular tool is free or not, as long as you stay within legal limits and shell out the minimum possible bucks?

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After the tweetup, where we had free beer for one and for all, we still had a few beers left and had planned to collect the whole crate the next day. Cut to next day, the whole crate was no where to be found.

too engrossed with the presentation to notice. And fuel was added to the fire by Narendra Bhandari, director of Asia Pacific, software and services group—developer relations division, Intel, who started off with a rocking video (*that* was super) on the screen, which got everyone hooked.

The hall managers were sweating, overwhelmed by the number of attendees that was beyond all expectations. Most were students, which indicates that the next generation is quite interested in the open source technologies. Bhandari discussed the evolution of smartphones. He drew an overall picture of the cell phone market that is constantly growing at a steady rate, stating that these devices are incorporated with operating systems that have custom interfaces to create interesting deviations of the user interface.

He said that most of these operating systems are Linux based. "We need cell phones or mobile data devices for entertainment, business critical uses, daily conveniences and a hybrid set of other uses. Moblin is a true open source platform for hybrid purpose devices. It is a Linux-based solution, which provides a rich media interface. You would want data on such devices to be synchronised with your home PC or to your corporate mail. Linux will be the viable choice in such cases," he stressed. For most of us who can't afford a Blackberry, *the times they are a-changin'* thanks to Linux—

powered mobile devices.

Rakshat Hooja, director, IDA Systems, while discussing 'The OpenMoko Experience', said that smartphones have growing hardware capabilities that can be leveraged, and more and more simple development platforms will emerge in the coming days. "The OpenMoko platform consists of truly open hardware as well as software. The OM hardware can run multiple software stacks, such as the OpenMoko stack, Nokia QT Extended, Debian and so on," he confirmed. Hooja suggested that by using OM, your phone could 'grow'. Rather than buying a phone every two years to get the latest set of features, all you need to do is update the phone's software like you update the OS in your PC.

Next up was Thilak Kumar, technical account manager, engineering division, Wind River. His talk included an enlightening presentation on the architecture of the Android stack, and its various licensing divisions. We got to know that the kernel has the GPL, but the rest of the stack is supported by APL (Apache Public License), save one shocking exception: the Dalvik VM, which is the heart and brain of the stack, is proprietary! And we enjoyed some live action too—a demo of Android on the emulator, live! And then Thilak was joined by Hooja and Bhandari for a panel discussion on the various mobile platforms.

The session was highly interactive

with a number of questions from the audience. But what stumped the panellists was the question: "Why are you giving me all this? Is there nothing you can offer that will run on my phone?" When the person who had asked the question was, in turn, queried what phone he was using, the reply was: "It's a 1100."

The CXOSummit on Virtualisation

The CXOSummit started with a talk on "Virtualisation and FOSS—What's the Connection?" by Srivathsa N.S., engineering manager, Dell India. He gave some insights into why virtualisation matters for the enterprise. He touched upon the technological aspect and also created the ideal atmosphere for the discussions to follow.

Next up was a panel discussion on "Why Cloud Computing, SaaS and Virtualisation would make business sense, especially coupled with FOSS, at a time when people are looking for cost cuts?" This was chaired by Arun Bhardwaj, senior manager of product marketing solutions, Dell. The panellists included Abhijit Das, Shishir Jain, CEO and president, Netcellence Technologies, N.S. Gowri Ganesh, project leader, CDAC Chennai, and P.K. Mishra.

This was a session that had the audience going in full swing, cross-questioning the panellists. The latter rose to the occasion, seeming to enjoy every question thrown at them. Some